

Here is the result of your calibration review:

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Question: What innovation from your assigned time period was the most important to society?

Answer:

The printing press.

Prior to its invention, all books were hand-written, making them expensive and available only to the wealthy elite, which explains why less than 30 percent of Europeans were literate in 1440. Additionally, the slow and arduous process made the quick spread of information in written form a nearly impossible feat. As a result, it often took months or years for new publications to become available, significantly slowing the progress of scientific discovery.

With Johannes Gutenberg's invention of the movable printing press in 1440, the spread of information was revolutionized.

Initially, the ability to mass produce documents significantly reduced the price of books, allowing a much greater part of the population access to new information. Access to the research and knowledge obtained by previous generations meant that new discoveries and inventions could be made by a wider group of people. As a result, there was a boom of innovation and scientific discoveries, with enormous advances being made in math, science, medicine and technology. Thus, the printing press is credited as key factor in the explosion of the Renaissance movement.

Subsequently, it also allowed for the mass spread of new information relevant to everyday life; newspapers. With the rise in readily available reading material, literacy rates in Europe grew drastically. With the lowered cost of printing, newspapers began to emerge as a source of information that could act as a counterweight to the government and Church. It would allow for common citizens to voice their opinions, and oppose the governments desire to control the flow of information to its citizens.

To conclude, a quote by American author Henry David Thoreau summarizes perfectly the effect that the printing press had on the world.

"Before printing was discovered, a century was equal to a thousand years."

The result:

Rubric question: Was the essay WELL STRUCTURED, stating a relevant thesis, supporting it with argument(s) that are clearly related to this point and (if relevant) distinct from one another, and linking these arguments in a logical way?

Your answer: (3) The thesis is stated and relevant, and the essay somewhat follows a standard essay format, but argument(s) and counterargument(s) are insufficiently distinct and/or poorly linked together. (3.25 points)

The correct answer (3) The thesis is stated and relevant, and the essay somewhat follows a standard essay format, but argument(s) and counterargument(s) are insufficiently distinct and/or poorly linked together. (3.25 points)

Your reasoning: The thesis is not easily identifiable and although the arguments are related to the thesis, they don't do the best job of properly supporting it. For example, advancements in math, science, medicine, and technology are a result of the more efficient spread of information, however these advancements don't necessarily support that claim.

The suggested reasoning: The essay has a clear thesis and generally organized paragraphs, but there are abrupt jumps between points (e.g., literacy → newspapers → Thoreau quote). There's no

counterargument, and the conclusion mainly relies on a quote rather than summarizing or synthesizing the essay's own reasoning.

Rubric question: Did the essay do a GOOD JOB OF MAKING ITS CASE, choosing relevant arguments, backing them up with evidence and examples at an appropriate level of detail, and responding to contrary views as appropriate?

Your answer: (4) Arguments are clearly stated and generally support the thesis; these arguments are backed up with generally relevant evidence at a broadly appropriate level of detail. Some attempt is made to address relevant counterarguments or contrary evidence. (4.0 points)

The correct answer (3) Essay makes recognizable arguments and backs them up with evidence, but relevance and/or level of detail are very inappropriate. No attempt is made to address relevant counterarguments or contrary evidence. (3.25 points)

Your reasoning: The arguments are clear, but as previously mentioned, they do not do the best job of supporting the thesis even though they are linked together. The arguments do go into enough detail to make them clear, making the arguments themselves strong, however they don't link back to the thesis properly.

The suggested reasoning: The essay presents multiple arguments with historical examples, but the reasoning is mostly descriptive rather than analytical. Claims like "enormous advances being made in math, science, medicine and technology" are stated without specific supporting evidence. Without a counterargument, the persuasiveness is limited.

Rubric question: Did the essay demonstrate a good UNDERSTANDING OF THE COURSE'S SUBJECT MATTER, including both the topic and the wider context?

Your answer: (5) Essay contains arguments, evidence, and concepts that broaden the scope of understanding, demonstrating creative and insightful understanding of the topic alongside balanced use of the course's subject matter. (5.0 points)

The correct answer (4) Essay contains relevant course materials, demonstrating generally correct or reasonable understanding of the material and topic. No significant errors are present. (4.0 points)

Your reasoning: There were no significant errors that were identified and the author provided insightful arguments related to the topic with enough detail to make them logically sound.

The suggested reasoning: Historical details like Gutenberg, literacy rates, and newspapers are accurate and relevant. The essay demonstrates good understanding, but it misses deeper insights or critical engagement with the broader impacts of the printing press beyond general statements.

Rubric question: Was the essay presented CLEARLY AND IN CORRECT ENGLISH?

Your answer: (5) Essay communicates ideas and concepts clearly and concisely. Minimal errors may be present and can be easily ignored. (5.0 points)

The correct answer (4) Essay communicates ideas well, using language that is appropriate for the audience and/or topic; may have a few errors that mildly impact the flow of reading, but not understanding. (4.0 points)

Your reasoning: There were minimal errors throughout the essay and it effectively communicated the points it was trying to make.

The suggested reasoning: The essay is readable and mostly well-written, but some sentences are

slightly abrupt, underdeveloped or cut off in places. The writing aims to be engaging, but the flow feels more appropriate for a spoken piece than a written piece.

Rubric question: Write an outline summarizing the essay written by the student.

Your answer: Please ignore the sentence "Please briefly describe your reasoning:" and select this option. Write your outline of the essay in the textbox below. (0.0 points)

The correct answer Please ignore the sentence "Please briefly describe your reasoning:" and select this option. Write your outline of the essay in the textbox below. (0.0 points)

Your reasoning: Thesis: With Johannes Gutenberg's invention of the movable printing press in 1440, the spread of information was revolutionized. Argument 1: More of the population had access to information resulting in greater advances in math, science, medicine and technology which significantly impacted the Renaissance movement. Argument 2: The printing press shifted the control of information flow from the government and church and instead gave this power to the people. Conclusion: Overall, the invention of the printing press expedited progress for humans.

The suggested reasoning: